

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:52

Hide

Annotate  More 

In the midst of the American Civil War, President Abraham Lincoln's adaptive and balanced leadership approach was characterized by his ability to maneuver various political pressures while maintaining focus on the Union's objectives. This nuanced leadership stood in contrast to the strategies of many of his contemporaries, whose approaches to governance during this tumultuous period were often more _____. While Lincoln navigated the complexities of war, emancipation, and national reunification with a mix of pragmatism and moral resolve, others in similar positions exhibited decision-making styles that differed markedly in their consistency and effectiveness.

1  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: inflexible



B: diplomatic



C: erratic



D: conciliatory



Question 1 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:38

Hide

Annotate  More 

In 1802, the Treaty of Amiens was signed, temporarily halting the hostilities between the British Empire and Napoleonic France. This agreement, however, was viewed skeptically by many British politicians and the public, who doubted its durability and the intentions of Napoleon. Their skepticism was contrasted with the more _____ attitude of Prime Minister Henry Addington's government, which advocated for the treaty as a necessary step towards lasting peace.

2  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: cautious



B: optimistic



C: indifferent



D: reactionary



Question 2 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:22

Hide

Annotate  More 

In William Gibson's *Neuromancer*, the protagonist Case, a disgraced computer hacker, is hired to pull off the ultimate hack. Gibson's novel, characterized by its vividly dystopian cyberpunk setting, is a pioneering work in its genre. The author's depiction of the Matrix, a virtual reality data constellation, is _____. Case's navigation through this digital landscape, filled with sentient AI and corporate overlords, is a reflection of the increasingly blurred lines between man and machine in our society. This seminal work has been instrumental in shaping the scope and tenor of contemporary science fiction literature.

3  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: archaic



B: groundbreaking



C: banal



D: anachronistic



Question 3 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:58

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is from Emily Dickinson's poem 'Hope is the thing with feathers'

'Hope' is the thing with feathers
That perches in the soul
And sings the tune without the words
And never stops - at all
And sweetest - in the Gale - is heard
And sore must be the storm
That could abash the little Bird
That kept so many warm
I've heard it in the chilliest land
And on the strangest Sea
Yet - never - in Extremity,
It asked a crumb - of me.

4  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To depict the resilience of the human spirit in the face of adversity



B: To illustrate the challenges of maintaining hope during difficult times



C: To emphasize the necessity of tangible rewards for sustaining hope



D: To metaphorically represent hope as a perpetual and self-sustaining force within the soul



Question 4 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:51

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Stephen King's 1982 novel 'The Gunslinger.' The protagonist, Roland, is in pursuit of a mysterious figure known as the Man in Black.

'The world had moved on,' said the Gunslinger. 'So had the Man in Black. The Gunslinger followed. He knew little of the man he pursued except that he was fleeing and that he had to be caught. The Gunslinger was relentless. He had seen deserts and mountains, rivers and plains, all in his unending pursuit. And still, he followed.'

5  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A: To illustrate the various landscapes that the Gunslinger has traversed in his pursuit.



B: To emphasize the Gunslinger's lack of knowledge about the Man in Black.



C: To depict the Gunslinger's despair and hopelessness in his relentless pursuit.



D: To convey the Gunslinger's unyielding determination to catch the Man in Black, despite the challenges.



Question 5 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:41

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Charles Dickens's *A Christmas Carol*. Scrooge is visited by the ghost of his old business partner, Jacob Marley.

"Marley, in his pigtail, usual waistcoat, tights, and boots; the tassels on the latter bristling, like his pigtail, and his coat-skirts, and the hair upon his head. The chain he drew was clasped about his middle. It was long, and wound about him like a tail; and it was made (for Scrooge observed it closely) of cash-boxes, keys, padlocks, ledgers, deeds, and heavy purses wrought in steel."

6  Mark for Review

Which choice best explains the main purpose of the extract?

A: To demonstrate the extravagant wealth accumulated by Marley in his lifetime

B: To create a powerful visual representation of Marley's moral and financial burdens in death

C: To illustrate the festive and celebratory attire worn by ghosts during Christmas time

D: To depict the eccentric fashion sense of the ghostly apparitions in the Victorian era

Question 6 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:24

Hide

Annotate  More 

Text 1

Thomas Mann, a German novelist and 1929 Nobel laureate, is best known for his works that capture the crisis of the artist and the psychology of the intellectual. Mann's works, such as 'Death in Venice' and 'The Magic Mountain', are acclaimed for their profound insight into the human condition. Despite the complex themes, Mann believed that the true purpose of literature was to provide enjoyment and enlightenment to the readers.

Text 2

Literary critic James Wood, while appreciating Mann's contribution to literature, presents a differing view. Wood argues that the psychological depth in Mann's works sometimes leads to an over-intellectualization, which can be distancing for the reader. He believes that literature should primarily serve to foster an emotional connection between the reader and the characters.

7 Mark for Review

Based on the texts, how would James Wood (Text 2) most likely respond to Thomas Mann's belief about the 'true purpose of literature' discussed in Text 1?

A: By asserting that Mann's belief is outdated and literature should now focus on addressing social and political issues



B: By disagreeing with Mann's belief and arguing that literature should primarily serve to analyze and critique societal norms



C: By suggesting that while Mann's belief about literature providing enjoyment and enlightenment is valid, the over-intellectualization in his works can be distancing for the readers



D: By proposing that literature should do away with complex themes and instead focus on simple narratives for better reader engagement



Question 7 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:16

Hide

Annotate  More 

The Treaty of Nijmegen (1678 - 79), ending the Franco-Dutch War, had surprisingly far-reaching effects on Asia. Primarily, it allowed Louis XIV's France to turn its attention to its interests in Asia, notably French India. The French East India Company, bolstered by the treaty, expanded its influence significantly. In addition, the United Provinces, weakened by the war, saw their influence in the region wane, leading to a shift in the power dynamics of colonial Asia.

8  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To argue that the Treaty of Nijmegen was the most important historical event of the 17th century



B: To explain how the Treaty of Nijmegen directly led to the creation of the French East India Company



C: To discuss how the Treaty of Nijmegen influenced the power dynamics in colonial Asia



D: To detail the specific articles included in the Treaty of Nijmegen and their implications for Asian territories



Question 8 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Francis Bacon, a philosopher of the 16th century, had a profound impact on scientific methodology. He argued that only clear, precise knowledge, obtained through direct observation and testing of hypotheses, could be considered true knowledge. He rejected the Aristotelian method of deductive reasoning, favoring instead an inductive approach based on empirical evidence. Bacon's views have greatly influenced the scientific method that is still in use today.

9  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To argue that Francis Bacon's philosophical ideas were wrong and misguided

B: To elaborate on Francis Bacon's personal life and his career as a philosopher

C: To highlight Francis Bacon's contributions to scientific methodology and his emphasis on empirical evidence

D: To detail the differences between Aristotelian deductive reasoning and Bacon's inductive approach

Question 9 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Smart cities use data and technology to improve the quality of urban life. In Barcelona, sensors installed in dustbins monitor waste levels and trigger collection when needed, reducing operational costs. In Singapore, a network of sensors on buildings, lampposts, and buses collect data about traffic, weather, and crowd behavior to optimize various city services. However, some critics argue that the technology-driven approach can lead to social inequality and increased surveillance. To argue against this, data scientist Dr. Hazel Kwon suggests that smart city technologies, if implemented with consideration for social equity, can promote inclusivity and civic engagement.

10  Mark for Review

Which of the following, if true, would most directly support Dr. Kwon's argument?

A: In a smart city pilot project, a community-based app used to report local issues resulted in increased civic participation and improved local governance.



B: In a certain smart city, high-tech surveillance systems led to a significant decrease in crime rates.



C: In an experiment, smart traffic management systems led to a decrease in road accidents and improved traffic flow.



D: In a survey, residents of smart cities reported higher satisfaction with public utilities compared to those in traditional cities.



Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

27:57

Hide

Annotate  More 

Solar energy engineer, Dr. Aiden Kim, discovered that solar panels in colder climates were performing better than those in warmer regions. In his study, he found that the photovoltaic cells in the solar panels in colder regions were more efficient due to their ability to conduct electricity better in lower temperatures. He observed that the cooler temperatures prevented the cells from overheating, thus maintaining their efficiency. Dr. Kim suggested that installing cooling systems on solar panels in warmer climates could enhance their performance to match those in colder regions.

11  Mark for Review

Which of the following, if true, would most strongly support Dr. Kim's suggestion?

A: Studies have shown that cooling systems can effectively reduce the operating temperature of solar panels and increase their energy output.

B: Solar panels in desert regions have been found to have a lower lifespan due to extreme heat conditions.

C: Several solar panel manufacturing companies are considering the use of heat-resistant materials.

D: In regions with cooler climates, solar panels have been found to require less maintenance.

Question 11 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Region	Period	Method of Assessment	Impact Score
France	Early 20th Century	Literary Influence Analysis	80-90
United States	Mid 20th Century	Cultural Impact Analysis	65-75
Russia	Late 20th Century	Political Impact Analysis	50-60
Germany	Early 21st Century	Artistic Impact Analysis	40-50

Guillaume Apollinaire is renowned for his innovative approach to poetry, influencing the development of Cubism in visual arts. However, his influence varied depending on the region and period. Scholars have argued that the impact of Apollinaire's work is significantly influenced by the geographical location and the sociopolitical context.

12 Mark for Review

Which choice best describes data from the table that support the scholars' suggestion?

- A: The impact score assessed through Literary Influence Analysis in France during the early 20th century was the lowest, while the impact score assessed through Cultural Impact Analysis in the United States during the mid-20th century was the highest. ⚙
- B: In Russia during the late 20th century, the Political Impact Analysis produced an impact score range with a minimum of 50 and a maximum of 60. ⚙
- C: The impact scores produced by France and the United States were similar to each other, while the scores produced by Russia and Germany each differed substantially from any other score. ⚙
- D: The estimated impact score produced for France exceeded the estimated impact score for Germany, even though both regions used the same method to generate their estimates. ⚙

Gilbert Ryle, a British philosopher, was widely known for his critique of what he termed the 'official doctrine', or Cartesian dualism. This dualism asserts the existence of two distinct entities, the mind and the body, which interact with each other. Ryle, however, proposed an alternative perspective, the 'behaviorist' model, which posits that mental states are not separate entities but rather particular kinds of behavior. Despite the significant shift this perspective brought about in philosophical understanding, Ryle's critics argue that his behaviorist model falls short in explaining the subjective experience of consciousness, leading Ryle to concede that his model might not fully encapsulate all aspects of human cognition, but rather _____.

13  Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: provides a simplistic understanding of complex neurological processes.



B: caters to the popular opinion of his contemporaries in the philosophical community.



C: offers a basic framework for understanding human behavior and mental states.



D: offers an alternative interpretation of mind-body interactions that challenges conventional thinking.



Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

27:28

Hide

Annotate  More 

Frederic Remington, a seminal figure in American Western art, skillfully captured the spirit and drama of the American frontier. His work, characterized by vivid details and dynamic compositions, has been instrumental in shaping the popular image of the Wild West. Remington's artwork not only depicted the harsh realities and rugged landscapes of the American West but also portrayed the cultural interactions and clashes between settlers and Native Americans. However, despite the widespread recognition of Remington's artistic contributions, some critics argue that his representations often romanticize the actual conditions of the frontier, thereby perpetuating certain myths. These critics contend that Remington's work, although undeniably influential, risks _____.

14  Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: undermining the historical significance of other American Western artists.



B: oversimplifying the complexities and nuances of life on the American frontier.



C: exaggerating the role of Native Americans in the development of the American West.



D: discrediting the artistic merit of contemporary interpretations of the American West.



Question 14 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

The Dark Ages, a period in European history that followed the fall of the Western Roman Empire, is often associated with a decline in knowledge and culture. However, this view is somewhat misleading. Despite the turmoil, there were significant advancements in various fields, such as agriculture, art, and architecture. _____ period saw the rise of powerful kingdoms and the spread of Christianity, which greatly influenced the course of Western civilization.

15 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Nonetheless this

B: Nonetheless, this

C: Nonetheless: this

D: Nonetheless; this

Question 15 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

27:13

Hide

Annotate  More 

The board's strategic planning session yielded a clear direction for the company's growth. The executives outlined three core _____ market share, enhancing digital transformation, and strengthening customer relationships. By addressing these focal points, the company aims to secure a competitive advantage in the rapidly evolving global marketplace. Each objective is designed to propel the organization towards increased profitability and industry leadership, demonstrating the board's vision for a successful future.

16  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: objectives: expanding



B: objectives - expanding



C: objectives, expanding



D: objectives; expanding



Question 16 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

The Pacific Ocean, covering more than 60 million square miles, is a vital habitat for a diverse range of marine life. It is home to thousands of species, many of which are not found anywhere else in the _____. Pacific Ocean plays a crucial role in regulating the planet's climate. However, human activities such as overfishing, pollution, and climate change are threatening this biodiversity. Therefore, it is essential to protect and conserve this precious resource.

17 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: world. Moreover, the

B: world, moreover, the

C: world; moreover the

D: world. Moreover - the

Question 17 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Although commonly associated with arid and hot environments, deserts can experience surprisingly cold temperatures at night. Due to the lack of humidity and cloud cover,

18 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: temperatures drop dramatically at night, often surprising those not accustomed to desert climates.

B: temperatures drops dramatically at night, often surprising those not accustomed to desert climates.

C: temperatures drop dramatically at nights, often surprising those not accustomed to desert climates.

D: temperature drop dramatically at night, often surprising those not accustomed to desert climates.

Artificial photosynthesis is a chemical process that replicates the natural process of photosynthesis. Scientists _____ to perfect this technology. If successful, it could provide a clean, renewable source of energy. The process involves capturing sunlight and converting it into chemical energy. This energy is then stored for later use. The goal is to create a system that can efficiently convert sunlight into usable energy.

19 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: is working hard

B: were working hard

C: are working hard

D: was working hard

Question 19 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

26:46

Hide

Annotate  More 

Renowned author John Green's critically acclaimed novel "The Fault in Our Stars," a recipient of the 2013 Goodreads Choice Award for Young Adult Fiction, is narrated through the perspective of _____ protagonist, sixteen-year-old Hazel Grace Lancaster.

20  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: diary entries supposedly penned by the novel's



B: diary entries supposedly penned by the novels'



C: diaries entries supposedly penned by the novels'



D: diaries entries supposedly penned by the novel's



Question 20 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

26:39

Hide

Annotate  More 

The Wizard of Earthsea is a fantasy novel written by Ursula K. Le Guin. The story revolves around a young boy named Ged who discovers he has magical powers. _____ for wizards where he learns to control his powers. However, in his arrogance, Ged releases a shadow creature into the world. The rest of the novel follows Ged's journey to defeat this creature and restore balance to the world.

21  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Ged attends a school



B: Ged attend a school



C: Ged attending a school



D: Ged attended a school



Question 21 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In the realm of environmental science, the concept of sustainability is often highlighted as crucial for future generations. Sustainable practices involve not only the conservation of natural resources but also ensuring economic and social stability. _____ the excessive reliance on fossil fuels has led to significant environmental degradation, demonstrating the urgent need for renewable energy sources. This shift is imperative not only for environmental health but also for the long-term viability of economies worldwide.

22  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,



B: Alternately,



C: Nevertheless,



D: Likewise,



In contemporary philosophy, the concept of the philosophy of history refers to the theoretical aspect of history. It involves the critical inquiry into the process by which history unfolds. Rather than merely cataloging events, it seeks to understand the 'why' and 'how' of historical developments. _____ it incorporates factors such as social dynamics, cultural shifts, and economic trends.

23 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: On the other hand,

C: For example,

D: However,

Question 23 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

African cosmology has had a profound influence on star lore around the world. For instance, in many African societies, the Pleiades star cluster is associated with agricultural cycles, signifying the beginning or end of growing seasons. _____ the constellation Orion was often viewed as a celestial representation of Osiris, the Egyptian god of the afterlife.

24 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Similarly,

B: Therefore,

C: However,

D: In contrast,

Question 24 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- George Washington was the first President of the United States.
- He played a pivotal role in the American Revolutionary War as the Commander-in-Chief of the Continental Army.
- Washington presided over the Constitutional Convention in 1787, which led to the drafting of the U.S. Constitution.
- He is often celebrated for his leadership qualities and his commitment to American republicanism.
- Washington's Farewell Address is notable for its advice on foreign policy and the dangers of political parties.

25 Mark for Review

The student wants to underscore George Washington's overarching impact on the early United States. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: As the first President, Washington's leadership and his Farewell Address set enduring precedents for American politics.



B: George Washington's leadership in the Revolutionary War and his guidance during the Constitutional Convention shaped the nation's foundation.



C: Washington's primary legacy lies in his role as the first President and his contributions to the drafting of the U.S. Constitution.



D: Celebrated for his commitment to republicanism, Washington's influence is most evident in his presiding role at the Constitutional Convention.



While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The osprey (*Pandion haliaetus*) is a bird of prey known for its remarkable fishing abilities. It primarily feeds on fish and has adapted unique methods to catch its prey.
- Unlike many other birds of prey, the osprey is known for its diving behavior.
- One notable characteristic is its ability to dive feet-first into water to catch fish.
- Another adaptation is its reversible outer toe, which allows it to grasp slippery fish more effectively.
- These features make the osprey a specialized fish hunter.

26 Mark for Review

The student is analyzing the osprey's hunting techniques and wants to highlight a key aspect of its adaptations for catching fish. Which choice effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: The osprey dives into water feet-first to catch fish, an adaptation not commonly seen in other birds of prey. ⚙

B: The osprey's ability to reverse its outer toe is unique among birds, aiding in its specialized fish-hunting technique. ⚙

C: One of the osprey's hunting methods includes diving feet-first into water, while the other involves using its reversible outer toe to catch fish. ⚙

D: In addition to diving feet-first, the osprey also hunts by swooping down over water to snatch fish from the surface. ⚙

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Deforestation is a major environmental issue.
- Large areas of the Amazon rainforest have been cleared for agriculture and logging.
- The Amazon rainforest is known as the 'lungs of the planet' due to its role in oxygen production and carbon dioxide absorption.
- Between 2000 and 2018, Brazil lost more than 30% of its forest cover.
- Efforts to combat deforestation include legal regulations and promoting sustainable agriculture.

27 Mark for Review

The student wants to discuss the impact of deforestation on the Amazon rainforest. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: In Brazil, deforestation has been an issue, with a significant amount of forest cover lost, but the specific impact on the Amazon rainforest is not clear.



B: Despite the Amazon rainforest being crucial for global oxygen production and carbon dioxide absorption, it has faced severe deforestation, with Brazil losing over 30% of its forest cover between 2000 and 2018.



C: Efforts to combat deforestation, such as legal regulations and sustainable agriculture, have been implemented in the Amazon rainforest.



D: The Amazon rainforest has been cleared for agriculture and logging, although it is unclear how this has affected its environmental role.



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:52

Hide

Annotate  More 

St. Peter, the foremost apostle of Jesus and the first Pope of the Catholic Church, holds a deeply impactful role in Christian history. His life and teachings continue to _____ the Church's doctrines, shaping the spiritual journey of millions. St. Peter's influence, even after his death, remains unyielding, guiding the Church's approach to faith and worship. His steadfast commitment to spreading the teachings of Jesus and his unwavering faith in the face of adversity have cemented his status as a pivotal figure in the Church's narrative.

1  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: inform



B: entertain



C: distract



D: amuse



Question 1 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:45

Hide

Annotate  More 

Fitness trackers, with their myriad features, have revolutionized personal health management. They allow individuals to monitor their physical activities, sleep patterns, and heart rates, among other variables. By providing real-time data, these devices encourage users to make informed decisions about their health and exercise regimes. However, the precision of these gadgets is often questioned. Critics argue that the data they generate can be misleading, causing users to _____ their physical capabilities or health status. Despite these concerns, the popularity of fitness trackers continues to soar, indicating that many people find their benefits outweigh the potential inaccuracies.

2  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: calculate



B: evaluate



C: rate



D: misjudge



Question 2 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:38

Hide

Annotate  More 

Renowned for his intricate and perplexing narratives, Franz Kafka's work has a distinct place in modernist literature. His bizarre stories, often laden with _____ characters, delve into themes of alienation, existential anxiety, guilt, and absurdity. Kafka's protagonists, often stuck in incomprehensible situations, showcase the struggle against an overwhelming, incomprehensible, and terrifyingly indifferent bureaucracy. This sense of helplessness and despair, mirrored in his real life, is a recurring theme in his work. Kafka's mastery in expressing the absurd and the grotesque has made his work a subject of extensive study and interpretation in literature circles.

3  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: kind



B: generous



C: enigmatic



D: joyful



Question 3 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:29

Hide

Annotate  More 

Sales tax is a consumption tax imposed by the government on the sale of goods and services. It is typically calculated as a percentage of the purchase price and varies depending on the location of the sale. Some areas may have multiple layers of sales tax, such as state and local governments. Sales tax revenue is often used to fund public services and infrastructure projects, making it an essential source of income for governments.

4  Mark for Review

Which choice best describes the main idea of the text?

A: The text aims to compare sales tax systems in different countries and evaluate their effectiveness.



B: The passage seeks to criticize the sales tax as an unfair burden on consumers and businesses.



C: The main idea is to analyze the different methods of calculating sales tax and the advantages of each method.



D: The primary focus is to describe sales tax as a consumption tax and its importance as a source of revenue for governments.



Question 4 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:23

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Gabriel Garcia Marquez's novel *One Hundred Years of Solitude*. Aureliano Babilonia is examining the parchments left by Melquiades, the gypsy.

Aureliano Babilonia would shut himself up for hours on end in his study, poring over the parchments that Melquiades had left him. In them, he found the history of his family written in coded language. The parchments had not only a historical but a prophetic value. They contained not only the past but also the future of the Buendía family. Aureliano Babilonia was the only one who could decipher them, and he knew that he was in possession of a secret that could engulf any man with overwhelming fascination.

5  Mark for Review

Which choice best identifies the primary purpose of this text?

A: To explain why Aureliano Babilonia isolates himself from his family and community

B: To highlight the loneliness and obsession that comes with discovering a family's history

C: To suggest that Aureliano Babilonia is losing his sanity due to his immersion in his family's past

D: To reveal Aureliano Babilonia's unique ability to interpret the prophetic and historical significance of the parchments

Question 5 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:16

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from John Steinbeck's *The Grapes of Wrath*. A family is travelling to California in search of work and a better life.

The family listened to the tires rumbling on the highway. The baby slept, the mother passed pieces of bread to the small boys. Al, the driver, was slouched down, his body moving robotically with the ruts in the road. The old man, Pa, looked out at the dry fields, the dust rising in small clouds. "That's a lonely country," Pa said. "Gives me the creeps."

But Ma looked at him and smiled. "It's a country," she said. "And it's a good country. We'll make it good, Pa."

6  Mark for Review

Which choice best describes the main purpose of the text?

A: To depict the hardships faced by the family on the road and their struggle for survival



B: To highlight the contrasting views of the family members towards their new home



C: To convey the varying attitudes within the family towards their journey and their future



D: To draw attention to the physical challenges of the journey and the relentless nature of the land



Question 6 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:10

Hide

Annotate  More 

Text 1

Swarm robotics is a field of robotics that involves coordinating the behavior of multiple robots. Traditional approaches tend to focus on pre-programmed behaviors and reactive decision-making based on the robots' environment. The aim is to achieve a collective behavior that can complete complex tasks more efficiently than individual robots.

Text 2

Dr. Julia Adams and her research team propose an alternative approach to swarm robotics. Instead of relying solely on pre-programmed behaviors, they suggest incorporating machine learning algorithms into the robots. This would allow the robots to learn from their experiences and adapt their behaviors over time, potentially making the swarm more effective and resilient.

7  Mark for Review

Based on the texts, how would Dr. Julia Adams and her team (Text 2) most likely respond to the "traditional approaches" discussed in Text 1?

A: By suggesting that traditional approaches might be limiting the potential of swarm robotics by not utilizing machine learning algorithms

B: By emphasizing that traditional approaches are outdated and should be completely replaced by machine learning-based methods

C: By stating that they share the same principles but differ in the application of machine learning in swarm robotics

D: By agreeing with the traditional approaches but proposing to add more pre-programmed behaviors to increase efficiency

Question 7 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In many African societies, the role of the baker is deeply interwoven into the cultural fabric. Bakers use traditional methods, passed down through generations, to create bread that is more than just sustenance. The bread they make is often used in various rituals and ceremonies, symbolizing unity and shared community. Moreover, the baker's role is also economic, providing a source of income and contributing to the local economy. Their craft is a testament to the rich culinary heritage of the continent.

8  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To highlight the cultural, ritualistic, and economic significance of the baker's role in African societies



B: To discuss the history of bread-making techniques used by African bakers



C: To explain the process of bread-making for different rituals and ceremonies in African societies



D: To emphasize the contribution of bakers to the sustenance of their communities in Africa



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:54

Hide

Annotate  More 

Robert Falcon Scott, a British explorer, led two expeditions to the Antarctic regions. His first expedition (1901-1904), although not reaching the South Pole, made significant contributions to scientific knowledge. The second expedition (1910-1912) was marked by a race against Roald Amundsen, a Norwegian explorer. Despite reaching the South Pole, Scott and his team tragically perished during the return journey.

9  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To highlight the rivalry and competition between Robert Falcon Scott and Roald Amundsen in exploring Antarctica



B: To emphasize the tragic end of Robert Falcon Scott and his team during their second expedition to the Antarctic regions



C: To provide a detailed account of the scientific contributions made by Robert Falcon Scott during his expeditions to Antarctica



D: To provide an overview of Robert Falcon Scott's two Antarctic expeditions, noting their significant events and outcomes



Question 9 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Mining Engineer, Maria Lopez and her team conducted an extensive study on the impact of coal mining on the surrounding environment. By analyzing the soil composition and water quality in regions where mining was prevalent, they discovered that areas closer to the mining sites had a higher concentration of heavy metals, leading to soil degradation. However, these regions showed an unexpected increase in certain plant species that are known to be tolerant to heavy metals. Lopez hypothesized that the mining activities, despite causing soil degradation, were indirectly promoting biodiversity by favoring these specific plant species.

10  Mark for Review

Which observation, if true, would most directly challenge Lopez's hypothesis?

A: In regions far from the mining sites, soil composition was found to contain minimal heavy metals, yet there was an increase in the same plant species.



B: In regions not included in the study, mining activities led to a decrease in the overall biodiversity, including the heavy metal-tolerant species.



C: In several areas not part of the study, there was a decrease in the specific plant species despite the presence of heavy metals in the soil.



D: In some areas included in the study, mining activities resulted in an increase in different plant species, not known to be heavy metal tolerant.



Question 10 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:41

Hide

Annotate  More 

The Treaty of Paris, signed in 1898, ended the Spanish-American War and significantly affected Asia. Spain ceded control of the Philippines to the United States, marking the U.S.'s first major overseas colony. Despite resistance from Filipino nationalists, who had been fighting for independence from Spain, the U.S. established a colonial government. The Treaty also raised questions about America's role in Asia, especially regarding the balance of power with other colonial nations. Historians argue that the Treaty laid the groundwork for the U.S.'s future involvement in Asian affairs, particularly in the Pacific theater during World War II.

11  Mark for Review

Which statement, if proven true, would most significantly support the argument that the Treaty of Paris had a profound impact on the U.S.'s future involvement in Asia?

A: The United States had previously shown little interest in overseas territories before the signing of the Treaty of Paris.



B: Following the Treaty of Paris, the United States started to establish more military bases in the Pacific, which were later used in World War II.



C: Spain, after losing the Philippines, focused its colonial efforts on Africa and largely withdrew from Asian affairs.



D: The Treaty of Paris was criticized by some American politicians who believed that the United States should not involve itself in colonial affairs.



Question 11 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Research Group	Year	Design Method	System Efficiency (%)	System Reliability Score (out of 10)
Smith and Johnson	2018	Integrated Design	85-92	9-10
Lee and Kim	2019	Sequential Design	70-78	7-8
Peterson and Davis	2020	Concurrent Design	80-88	8-9
Brown and Miller	2021	Integrated Design	86-93	9-10

Mechatronics engineering is a multidisciplinary field that integrates mechanical, electronic and software engineering. The nature of the domain leads to varied approaches in the design of mechatronics systems. Professors Smith and Johnson argue that the design strategy greatly influences the system's efficiency and reliability.

12 Mark for Review

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Smith and Johnson's argument?

A: The study by Lee and Kim used sequential design and had the least system efficiency and reliability scores, while the study by Smith and Johnson had the highest.

B: In their study, Peterson and Davis used concurrent design to produce a system efficiency range of 80-88% and a system reliability score of 8-9.

C: The efficiency and reliability scores produced by Smith and Johnson and by Brown and Miller are similar, while the scores produced by Lee and Kim and by Peterson and Davis each differed substantially from any other score.

D: The system efficiency produced by Smith and Johnson was slightly higher than the one produced by Brown and Miller, even though both groups used the same design method.

The Arctic fox (*Vulpes lagopus*) is a small mammal adapted to living in cold environments, primarily found in the Arctic regions. Its evolutionary history has been a subject of study among scientists for years. Dr. Emily Zhao, a geneticist at the University of Stockholm, conducted a study on the genetic diversity of the Arctic fox. Her research revealed that the Arctic fox's genetic makeup had significant variations, leading to adaptations for extreme cold. These adaptations include a thick fur coat and a unique metabolic rate to survive in sub-zero temperatures. Zhao's team discovered that the genetic divergence between the Arctic fox and its closest relative, the red fox, occurred approximately 390,000 years ago. This divergence coincided with a period of significant climatic cooling during the Pleistocene epoch. Given these findings, the team concluded that _____.

13 Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the Arctic fox is a recent evolutionary adaptation to the Arctic environment. ⚑

B: the Arctic fox and the red fox share a common ancestor that was adapted to cold environments. ⚑

C: the unique adaptations of the Arctic fox are a result of recent climate change. ⚑

D: the evolutionary adaptations of the Arctic fox align with historical climate shifts. ⚑

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:15

Hide

Annotate  More 

Overfishing, the practice of catching fish from a body of water at a rate that the species cannot replenish, presents a significant threat to marine biodiversity. This issue is particularly acute in the case of large, predatory fish species, whose numbers have declined by over 90% in the past half-century. These species play a crucial role in maintaining the balance of marine ecosystems, and their decline can trigger a cascade of negative effects throughout the food web. Moreover, the use of indiscriminate fishing practices such as bottom trawling, which destroys seafloor habitats and catches non-target species, exacerbates the issue. Despite international efforts to regulate fishing practices and establish marine protected areas, the threat of overfishing persists, largely due to _____.

14

 Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the increased demand for seafood products due to population growth.



B: the discovery of new, previously unexploited fish species.



C: the lack of enforcement of fishing regulations and the prevalence of illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing.



D: the development of more efficient fishing technologies that reduce bycatch.



Question 14 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:07

Hide

Annotate  More 

Researchers investigating the principles of photosynthesis have determined why certain aquatic plants in the Northern Hemisphere grow towards the surface of the water. Contrasting with similar species in the Southern Hemisphere, which exhibit the opposite behavior due to _____ in the Northern Hemisphere, sunlight penetrates the water from above, encouraging plants to grow upwards towards the light. Conversely, in the Southern Hemisphere, light diffraction patterns caused by the angle of the sun result in a different growth direction, away from the surface and towards deeper waters.

15  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: different light absorption rates:



B: different light absorption rates,



C: different light absorption rates while



D: different light absorption rates



Question 15 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:01

Hide

Annotate  More 

In a recent study exploring the impact of workplace environment on productivity, researchers observed the lighting conditions in various offices. The brightness of the lights in the offices _____ in some locations, they were extremely bright, while in others, they were kept at a more subdued level. The study found that lighting intensity had a significant effect on employee productivity and mood.

16

 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: varied:



B: varied,



C: varied, while



D: varied while



Question 16 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:53

Hide

Annotate  More 

The field of bioengineering is vast and complex, encompassing numerous sub-disciplines and areas of study. One such area is the development of artificial organs, which involves the creation of synthetic replacements for human organs. These replacements can be made from various materials, including biocompatible plastics, metals, and ceramics, as well as _____ to mimic the function of the original organ. This groundbreaking work is not only saving lives but also advancing our understanding of human biology and physiology.

17  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: living cells, both human and animal, 

B: living cells, both human and animal; 

C: living cells; both human and animal, 

D: living cells both human and animal, 

Question 17 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Novelist George Orwell's works are considered seminal in British literature. However, many of the _____ of dystopian societies were initially written for political commentaries; Orwell's intention was to critique totalitarian regimes.

18  Mark for Review

Which choice best completes the passage so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: novelist's early novels'



B: novelists early novels



C: novelist's early novels



D: novelists' early novels



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:39

Hide

Annotate  More 

Computer-Aided Engineering (CAE) is a broad term that refers to the use of computers in designing, analyzing, and manufacturing products. Engineers often use CAE tools to simulate and visualize scenarios that would be too expensive or dangerous to test in real life. These tools _____ engineers approach their work, allowing them to make more informed decisions and improve the quality of their designs.

19  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has revolutionized the way



B: have revolutionized the way



C: having revolutionized the way



D: had revolutionized the way



Question 19 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In modern urban planning, green spaces are essential for maintaining environmental balance. In densely populated cities, _____

20  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: these spaces provide crucial natural habitats, often bringing much-needed wildlife into urban areas.



B: these space provides crucial natural habitats, often bringing much-needed wildlife into urban areas.



C: these spaces provides crucial natural habitats, often bringing much-needed wildlife into urban areas.



D: these spaces provide crucial natural habitat, often bringing much-needed wildlife into urban area.



Existentialism, a philosophical movement that dominated 20th-century philosophy, emphasizes the existence of the individual as a free and responsible agent. This movement, which was primarily influenced by the works of Søren Kierkegaard and Friedrich Nietzsche, argues that individuals _____ and must take personal responsibility for themselves. Existentialists believe that life is a series of choices, creating stress and anxiety but also offering freedom and opportunities.

21 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: is entirely free

B: were entirely free

C: are entirely free

D: be entirely free

Question 21 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Animals are often overlooked as crucial contributors to climate change. Their various life processes, such as digestion and excretion, can generate large amounts of greenhouse gases, especially in densely populated industrial farming environments. _____ they can also contribute to climate change through habitat destruction, such as deforestation for grazing lands.

22  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: However,



B: Moreover,



C: Therefore,



D: Alternatively,



Autonomous vehicles are purported to bring about a significant change in the field of transportation, reducing the frequency of traffic accidents and increasing efficiency in fuel consumption. They are designed to perceive their surroundings and navigate without human input, using technologies like radar, lidar, GPS, and computer vision. _____ these vehicles also have the potential to redefine urban spaces, as less space would be needed for parking lots, more lanes could be accommodated on the roads, and traffic could be better managed.

23  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Furthermore,

B: However,

C: Despite this,

D: In the past,

Question 23 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In the field of psychology, the concept of cognitive dissonance plays a pivotal role. This phenomenon occurs when an individual holds two or more contradictory beliefs, ideas, or values. The discomfort caused by this dissonance often leads to an alteration in one of the conflicting attitudes, beliefs, or behaviors to reduce the discomfort and restore balance. _____ in a case study involving smokers who were aware of the health risks, many justified their behavior by downplaying the risks or citing the benefits of smoking, thus alleviating their cognitive dissonance

24  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: For instance,



B: By contrast,



C: Specifically,



D: In conclusion,



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:58

Hide

Annotate  More 

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Ernest Hemingway was an American author and journalist.
- He won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1954.
- Hemingway's style is known for its simplicity and directness.
- He often used an iceberg theory of writing, leaving much unsaid and beneath the surface.
- The Old Man and the Sea is one of his most famous works.

25  Mark for Review

The student wants to convey the unique writing style of Hemingway. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: Hemingway, a Nobel laureate, is famous for his journalistic career and American heritage.



B: Ernest Hemingway's writing is marked by a simple, direct style and an iceberg theory, leaving much unsaid.



C: Hemingway's novel, The Old Man and the Sea, demonstrates his use of complex and elaborate language.



D: The Old Man and the Sea, one of Hemingway's lesser-known works, showcases his typical writing style.



Question 25 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Human Genome Project was an international research project that aimed to map the entire human genome.
- It was a 13-year project coordinated by the US Department of Energy and the National Institutes of Health.
- The project was completed in 2003, two years ahead of its original schedule.
- The data from the project has been made freely available to researchers around the world.
- The project has led to significant medical and scientific discoveries.

26 Mark for Review

The student wants to describe the impact of the Human Genome Project. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: The Human Genome Project was a long-term international research project that was completed two years ahead of schedule.

B: The Human Genome Project was coordinated by the US Department of Energy and the National Institutes of Health.

C: The Human Genome Project, completed in 2003, has made significant contributions to medical and scientific discoveries by making its data freely available to researchers worldwide.

D: The Human Genome Project aimed to map the entire human genome and was a 13-year project.

Question 26 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:43

Hide

Annotate  More 

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Archimedes was a Greek mathematician, physicist, and inventor.
- Archimedes is known for his contributions to geometry, particularly the measurement of geometric shapes and volumes.
- The Archimedes' Principle states that the buoyant force on an object submerged in a fluid is equal to the weight of the fluid displaced by the object.
- Archimedes is also credited with inventing the Archimedes' Screw, a device used to raise water from a lower to a higher level.

27  Mark for Review

Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to describe Archimedes' significant contribution to the field of physics?

A: Archimedes' work in geometry, especially in measuring shapes and volumes, revolutionized the field of mathematics.



B: Archimedes, primarily known for his mathematical genius, also made some contributions to physics with the Archimedes' Principle.



C: Archimedes' major contribution to physics was the invention of the Archimedes' Screw, which is used for water irrigation.



D: Archimedes' Principle, stating that the buoyant force on a submerged object equals the weight of the displaced fluid, is a cornerstone in physics.



Question 27 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early